HR-OB Success and Failure

Infosys Limited

- Founded in 1981, Infosys grew from a small startup with seven engineers into one of the world's leading IT and consulting firms.
- A key driver of this success has been its **human resource management (HRM) philosophy and OB practices** that focus on people development, employee engagement, and continuous learning.

Key OB-HR Practices Behind Their Success

- **Learning and Development Culture-** Continuous learning is encouraged through the **"Lex" platform** — a digital learning hub.
- **Talent Management and Career Growth**

➢Structured career paths with transparent promotion systems.

➢Regular performance feedback and competency-based appraisals

- **Employee Engagement and Retention**
- Initiatives like "Infosys Cares" and "InfyMe" app focus on employee well-being and mental health.
- Open communication culture — employees can directly share suggestions or grievances through internal portals.

- ***Diversity and Inclusion***

Active promotion of gender diversity through initiatives like “Women in Leadership (WIN)” programs.Policies supporting flexible work arrangements and maternity benefits.

Values and Ethical Leadership-

Infosys emphasizes its core values — Customer Delight, Integrity, Fairness, and Transparency.

Leadership programs focus on ethical decision-making and people-first approaches.

Result

- Infosys became the **first Indian company to list on NASDAQ**.
- Consistently ranks among the **“Best Employers in India”** (Great Place to Work, LinkedIn, Forbes).
- Low attrition rates compared to industry averages during its growth phase.
- Strong employer brand helped attract top global talent.

Jet Airways

Jet Airways was once India’s largest private airline and a respected global brand. Founded in 1993, it dominated the Indian aviation market for over a decade.

However, by 2019, the company shut down operations due to financial distress — and ineffective HR management played a major role in its downfall.

Key OB-HR Mistakes That Led to Failure

- Poor Employee Relations and Communication
- Unfair Compensation Practices
- Low Morale and Lack of Engagement
- Ineffective Leadership and HR Alignment- *There was **no long-term workforce planning** — overstaffing in some areas and skill shortages in others.*
- Failure in Change Management - *When low-cost carriers like IndiGo and SpiceJet disrupted the market, Jet Airways did not reskill or reorient employees for new competitive demands.*

Result

- Employee strikes and negative publicity damaged brand reputation.
- Loss of customer trust and investor confidence.
- In April 2019, Jet Airways **ceased operations**, leaving over **20,000 employees jobless**.
- Many industry analysts cite **poor HR and communication practices** as one of the key internal causes of the collapse.

- Jet Airways shows that even a strong business can collapse if OB- **HR practices ignore transparency, fairness, and employee trust**.
- Effective HR isn't just about hiring — it's about **communication, engagement, and alignment between people and strategy**.